Ohio LLC Formation Guide

Isocline Labs LLC — Single-Member, Member-Managed

Prepared for Starla Cortes

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Draft only — not legal advice. Review with an attorney or the Ohio SBDC (free counseling, see `planning/BUSINESS_AND_LAUNCH_PLAN.md` §8) before filing.

1 Decisions locked in

Item	Value
Entity name	Isocline Labs LLC
Jurisdiction	Ohio
Membership	Single-member
Management	Member-managed
Statutory agent	You, using an Ohio address
Filing fee	$99 (non-refundable)

2 Articles of Organization (Ohio Form 533A)

File online at **Ohio Business Central** (`https://business.ohio.gov`) — same-day processing. The paper Form 533A is only needed if you mail it; the online form asks the same questions.

Form field	Entry
Article 1 — Name	`Isocline Labs LLC`
Article 2 — Effective date	Leave blank (effective on filing date)
Article 3 — Period of existence	Leave blank (defaults to perpetual)
Article 4 — Purpose	`Any lawful purpose`
Article 5 — Statutory agent	Your full legal name, plus your Ohio street address (a P.O. box is **not** acceptable; must be a physical street address in Ohio).
Article 6 — Additional provisions	Leave blank (add indemnification language only if your attorney advises)
Signatory	Your name and signature as authorized representative

2.1 Statutory agent notes

- The agent must maintain a physical presence at the listed Ohio address during business hours to accept service of process.
- **Your name and address become public record** on the Ohio SOS business search. If you do not want your home address public, use a commercial registered-agent service instead.
- Ohio does not require a separate "agent acceptance" form when the agent is the same person signing the Articles.

3 Operating Agreement

Ohio law requires an operating agreement (not filed with the state, but you must keep one with your records). Sign it yourself — as single-member you sign both as "Member" and as "Manager." Why it matters even though you are the only owner: it is the document that proves the LLC is a real, separate entity and not your personal alter ego. That separation is what keeps personal assets protected and is what a bank or investor will ask to see.

4 EIN (IRS Form SS-4) — free, online

Apply at `https://www.irs.gov/ein` (the online assistant issues the number instantly during business hours).

SS-4 field	Entry
Legal name	`Isocline Labs LLC`
Entity type	Limited liability company
Number of members	1 ("disregarded entity" for federal tax — profits/losses flow to your personal return)
Reason for applying	"Started a new business"
Responsible party	Your name + SSN (the IRS requires a natural person, not the LLC)

A single-member LLC with no employees does not strictly need an EIN — you can use your SSN — but an EIN is free, keeps your SSN off vendor/bank forms, and most banks require one to open a business account. Get it.

5 Post-formation checklist (in order)

☐ File Articles of Organization ($99) — save the confirmation/certificate.

☐ Sign and keep the operating agreement.

☐ Apply for EIN (free).

☐ Open a **business bank account** in the LLC's name (bring Articles + EIN + operating agreement). Do not mix personal and business funds from day one.

☐ Register for Ohio **Commercial Activity Tax (CAT)** only if/when taxable gross receipts exceed $150,000/year — not relevant at launch. No other Ohio LLC tax registration is automatic.

☐ Update the trademark worksheet: the "Owner of Mark" is now `Isocline Labs LLC`, organized in Ohio. This unblocks the TEAS Plus filing.

☐ File the trademark (TEAS Plus, Class 9, §1(b)) once the LLC is formed and the class 9 clearance search is done.

☐ Enroll in the **App Store Small Business Program** and align it with the LLC + developer account.

6 What not to worry about yet

- **No Ohio annual report fee** — Ohio LLCs pay no annual report; nothing is due every year at the state level.

- **No publication requirement** — Ohio does not require newspaper publication (unlike NY/NE).
- **No registered-agent acceptance filing** when you are your own agent.